

Blue highlight = must-remember · **IMPORTANT** = asked in past papers · [BOOK p.xxx ↗](#) = click to open the textbook at that page · Orange box = conflict/trap between sources.

QUICK REVISION · Numbers, Mnemonics & Rapid-Fire MCQs

Numbers to remember

Fact	Number	Fact	Number
Pāṇini's sūtras	3,983 (8 ch × 4 pādas)	Maheśvara Sūtras	14
R̥gveda hymns / verses / maṇḍalas	1,028 / 10,552 / 10	Sāmaveda verses	1,549
Atharvaveda hymns / mantras / books	730 / ~6,000 / 20	Vedāṅgas / Darśanas (āstika)	6 / 6
Gāyatrī / Anuṣṭup syllables	24 / 32	Gaṇas (Piṅgala)	8 (3-bit words)
Brahmagupta rules for zero	628 CE	Āryabhaṭīya	499 CE, 121 verses, 4 pādas
Mahāyuga	4,320,000 yr	Pañcāṅga limbs	5 (tithi, vāra, nakṣatra, yoga, karaṇa)
Tithis in a lunar month	30 (12° each)	Nakṣatras / yogas	27 (13°20')
Karaṇas	11 (4 fixed + 7)	Adhika māsa	every ~32–33 months
Wootz carbon	1–1.5%	Delhi Pillar	7.2 m, 99.7% Fe, 5th c. CE
Zinc distillation (Zawar)	9th–13th c., ~1000 °C	Crucible steel furnace	~1400 °C
π values	3.088 · 3.1416 · 3927/1250 · 11 dp (Mādhava)	Sine table (Āryabhaṭa)	24 intervals of 3.75°, R = 3438'
Dhanus / Gṛhapatya dhanus	96 / 108 aṅgula	Harappan brick ratio	4 : 2 : 1
64 Kalās · Pañcakośa	64 · 5	Eight limbs of Vāstu	8 (Sthāpatya → Ābharaṇa)
Saptāṅga	7 elements	Śāḍguṇya	6 policies
SDGs	17 (UN, 2015)	Turmeric / Neem patents revoked	1997 / 2000

Mnemonics

- **Vedāṅga body:** Chandas = feet, Kalpa = hands, Jyotiṣa = eyes, Nirukta = ears, Śikṣā = nose, Vyākaraṇa = mouth.

- **Pañcāvayava: P-H-U-U-N:** Pratijñā, Hetu, Udāharaṇa, Upanaya, Nigamana.
- **Fallacies: S-V-P-S-K:** Savyabhicāra, Viruddha, Prakaraṇasama, Sādhyasama, Kālātīta.
- **Pañchāṅga: T-V-N-Y-K** (Tithi, Vāra, Nakṣatra, Yoga, Karaṇa). **Rāśi is NOT one.**
- **Saptāṅga: S-A-J-D-K-D-M:** Svāmin, Amātya, Janapada, Durga, Kośa, Daṇḍa, Mitra.
- **Dosha elements:** Vāta = **A**ir+ether, Pitta = **F**ire, Kapha = **W**ater+earth.
- **Śāḍguṇya:** Sandhi, Vighraha, Āsana, Yāna, Saṃśraya, Dvaidhībhāva.
- **Guru conditions:** Long, Cluster, Anusvāra/visarga, Last.

Rapid-fire (likely Part A)

Question	Answer
IKS means (SEE 1.2)	Indigenous systems of knowledge evolved in India over millennia
Pratyakṣa (SEE 1.3)	Direct perception
Western education in India emphasised	Discipline-centric (specialised) knowledge, replacing integrated learning
Takṣaśilā and Nālandā	Ancient centres of higher learning
Which text is in the Vedic corpus?	Upaniṣads (Purāṇas, Smṛti, Itihāsa are not)
Sā vidyā yā vimuktaye / Satyaṃ vada dharmaṃ cara	Knowledge leads to liberation / Taittirīya Upaniṣad
Indian philosophical systems differ because they	Encourage multiple viewpoints (and debate)
Language of knowledge transmission; traditional education centre	Sanskrit; Gurukula system
Primary mode of Gurukula learning	Debate and memorisation (Śravaṇa, Manana, Nididhyāsana)
Piṅgala's binary ideas came from studying	Chandas (metre)
Primary character of Śruti	Oral tradition / revelation
Vedāṅga for phonetics	Śikṣā
Vedāṅga called "mouth"	Vyākaraṇa
Philosophy of logic & epistemology	Nyāya
Component dealing with philosophical inquiry into Ātman	Upaniṣads
Transition trad. → Western knowledge (colonial)	Epistemological shift
Tarka (as in philosophical systems)	Dialectical reasoning
TK vs modern science	TK holistic & community-based; modern reductionist
Veda that is "Book of Songs"	Sāmaveda (1,549 verses)
Śukla vs Kṛṣṇa Yajurveda	Mantra & brāhmaṇa separate vs mixed
Cārvāka accepts only	Pratyakṣa
Anekāntavāda	Jainism
Author of Aṣṭādhyāyī / sūtras	Pāṇini / 3,983 (not 3000, 3500, 4200)
Maheśvara Sūtras purpose	Organise phonemes into groups
Style of Pāṇini's grammar	Sūtra style
Suffixes for nouns / verbs	sup / tiṅ

Basic element for word generation	Dhātu / prātipadika
Sthāna	Place of articulation
Bhūta-saṃkhyā uses	Objects, beings, concepts
Kaṭapayādi	Consonants encode numbers; memory aid (not encryption)
Pramāṇa by similarity	Upamāna
Which is a pramāṇa? (Prameya/Saṃśaya/Pratyakṣa/Saṃskāra)	Pratyakṣa
Steps in Anumāna	Five
Objects of valid knowledge	Prameya
Process of inquiry starts with	Saṃśaya (doubt)
Pingala's gaṇas ↔ modern	de Bruijn sequence
Laghu : Guru in binary	1 : 0
Meru-prastāra ↔	Pascal's triangle
Zero as placeholder → number thanks to	Place-value system
Rules for zero & negative numbers	Brahmagupta
Mathematics compared to	Crest on peacock's head
Śulba Sūtras relate to	Geometry
Sine in ancient India	Jyā
Earth rotates on axis	Āryabhaṭa
Primary source of Vedic astronomy	Vedāṅga Jyotiṣa
Instrument for shadows / time	Gnomon (śaṅku) / Ghaṭī yantra (water clock)
Nakṣatras in the sky	27 lunar mansions
Wootz steel	High-carbon; Damascus swords
Lost-wax casting	Cire perdue; wax = beeswax
Sand-bath yantra	Vāluka yantra
Indigo from	Leaf
Perfume science	Gandhayukti / Gandhaśāstra; "attar" (itr)
Vāta / Pitta / Kapha elements	Air+ether / Fire+water / Water+earth
Dominant age: Kapha / Pitta / Vāta	Childhood / Adulthood / Old age
Kapha imbalance guṇa	Tamas
Meditation & ethical living raise	Sattva
BMI-C information flow	Senses → Mind → Intellect → Action
Sleep & nutrition improve first	Body
Most famous 64-Kalā list	Kāma Sūtra (Vātsyāyana)

Vāstu treatise / basic unit	Mānasāra / Pada
Best direction in Vāstu	East
Harappan planning	Grid + drainage
Garbhagṛha / Vimāna	Sanctum / sanctum tower
Gopurams	Drāviḍa (gateway towers)
Curvilinear śikhara · star plan	Nāgara · Hoysala (Vesara)
Water management of South India	Tanks (ēri)
Rāmāyaṇa governance	Welfare-oriented
Janapada / Durga / Kośa / Daṇḍa / Mitra	Territory+people / fort / treasury / punishment-law / ally
Not in Saptāṅga	Dharma
Internal security element	Daṇḍa
Arthaśāstra views king as	Servant of the state
Text of diplomacy, war, peace	Arthaśāstra
TKDL	Protect Indian traditional knowledge (against biopiracy)
IKS aligned with SDGs via	Sustainability; Sarvodaya
Ayurveda ↔ which SDG	SDG 3 Good Health & Well-being